

Recovering Latent Distance-Deterrence Parameters from Aggregate Travel-Distance Distributions for Survey-Free Spatial Interaction Modeling

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Abstract

Accurate origin–destination (OD) flow estimation is fundamental to transportation planning, accessibility analysis, infrastructure assessment, and urban decision-making. Gravity-model calibration traditionally requires identifying city-specific distance-deterrence parameters from complete observed OD matrices. Although privacy-preserving aggregate mobility data are increasingly available, it remains unknown whether aggregate travel-distance distributions preserve sufficient statistical information for parameter identification without observing OD interactions. This study investigates whether latent distance-deterrence parameters can be identified directly from aggregate travel-distance distributions. Aggregate travel-distance distributions are extracted from Meta Movement Distribution Maps and formulated within a multinomial likelihood framework to infer latent distance-deterrence parameters. The inferred parameters closely match locally calibrated references and produce statistically comparable OD prediction performance across multiple metropolitan areas without requiring target-city OD observations. The findings demonstrate that aggregate travel-distance distributions preserve sufficient statistical information to identify latent city-specific distance-deterrence parameters. Building on this finding, the proposed probabilistic calibration framework enables transferable and privacy-preserving gravity-model calibration for data-scarce cities using only aggregate mobility observations.

Keywords: Spatial interaction, distance deterrence, gravity models, aggregate mobility data, parameter identification, zero-shot calibration, privacy-preserving mobility

1 Introduction

Accurate origin–destination (OD) flow estimation is fundamental to transportation planning, accessibility analysis, infrastructure assessment, and urban decision-making (Barbosa et al. 2018; González et al. 2008; Song et al. 2010). Spatial interaction modeling represents the core analytical engine for estimating population mobility patterns across urban spaces. Gravity models (Wilson 1971; Tanner 1961) provide one of the most widely used probabilistic formulations of spatial interaction

because they explicitly characterize how travel demand emerges from the interplay between origin production, destination attractiveness, and distance deterrence. Their predictive capability, however, depends critically on identifying appropriate city-specific distance-deterrence parameters.

The fundamental bottleneck in spatial interaction modeling lies in observation rather than model formulation. Identifying distance-deterrence parameters traditionally requires

observing complete origin–destination flow matrices or individual mobility trajectories. However, comprehensive travel surveys are expensive and conducted infrequently (Egu and Bonnel 2020; Hussain et al. 2021), while trajectory records are tightly restricted by data privacy regulations and commercial licensing (de Montjoye et al. 2013). Consequently, conventional calibration methods fail in data-scarce urban regions worldwide because the necessary origin–destination observations are unavailable.

Aggregate mobility products—including Meta’s Movement Distribution Maps (MDM) (Meta 2026)—are becoming increasingly available across global platforms and regions, providing privacy-preserving summaries of population travel patterns without revealing origin–destination pairs. Aggregate travel-distance distributions remove origin–destination identities while preserving the statistical distribution of travel distances across an urban area, suggesting a fundamentally different observation layer for spatial interaction systems. Existing studies have demonstrated that aggregate mobility products are valuable for descriptive travel analysis, accessibility assessment, and epidemiological monitoring (Oliver et al. 2020; Buckee et al. 2020; Pappalardo et al. 2023). Whether aggregate travel-distance distributions preserve sufficient statistical information for identifying latent spatial interaction parameters without observing origin–destination interactions, however, has not been established. Resolving this fundamental observation gap forms the central focus of this study.

This study is founded on the central scientific hypothesis that *aggregate travel-distance distributions preserve sufficient statistical information to identify latent city-specific distance-deterrence parameters*. To systematically evaluate this hypothesis, we construct a sequential chain of three testable scientific predictions. First (**Prediction 1 — Statistical Identifiability**), aggregate travel-distance observations induce a statistically valid multinomial likelihood for identifying latent distance-deterrence parameters. Second (**Prediction 2 — Parameter Consistency**), building on Prediction 1, distance-deterrence parameters identified from aggregate travel-distance distributions are statistically consistent with reference parameters calibrated from

complete origin–destination interactions. Third (**Prediction 3 — Predictive Consequence**), building on Prediction 2, distance-deterrence parameters identified from aggregate observations preserve the downstream predictive performance of gravity-model calibration in unobserved target cities.

The scientific contributions of this study operate through a logical dependency structure across three distinct layers. At the core layer (**Layer 1 — Scientific Discovery**), we demonstrate that aggregate travel-distance distributions preserve sufficient statistical information to identify latent city-specific distance-deterrence parameters without observing origin–destination interactions. Building on this discovery (**Layer 2 — Methodological Contribution**), we establish a probabilistic parameter-identification framework to infer latent distance-deterrence parameters directly from aggregate travel-distance observations and integrate them into gravity-model calibration. Finally (**Layer 3 — Practical Contribution**), we enable transferable, survey-free, and privacy-preserving gravity-model calibration for data-scarce cities lacking target-city OD observations.

The remainder of this paper is organized as follows. Section 2 reviews related work on spatial interaction modeling, parameter identification, aggregate mobility representations, and survey-free prediction. Section 3 presents the proposed probabilistic parameter-identification framework, establishing its mathematical formulation across five distinct layers. Section 4 empirically evaluates the three scientific predictions across 50 US metropolitan areas. Section 5 discusses scientific implications, scope, limitations, and future directions. Section 6 concludes the paper.

2 Related Work

Spatial interaction modeling has long relied on classical frameworks such as gravity formulations (Wilson 1971) or parameter-free radiation models (Simini et al. 2012) for travel demand forecasting, accessibility assessment, and urban policy evaluation. In recent years, deep learning and graph neural networks (e.g., DeepGravity (Simini et al. 2021), TransGM (Enaya et al. 2026), and GODDAG (Rong et al. 2023a)) have significantly

Table 1 Comparative analysis of spatial interaction approaches across modeling paradigms, statistical representation layers, and observation requirements.

Model Class	Decomposed Structure	Transferable Across Cities	Requires Target OD	Interpretable	Deterrence Explicitly Modeled
Gravity (Wilson 1971)	Yes	No	Yes	High	Yes
Radiation (Simini et al. 2012)	No	Yes	No	High	Yes
DeepGravity (Simini et al. 2021)	No	Limited	Yes	Low	No
Graph-based OD (MPGCN) (Hu et al. 2020)	No	Limited	Yes	Low	No
Graph Transfer Learning (GODDAG) (Rong et al. 2023a)	Partial	Yes	Yes	Low	No
Gravity-Informed Neural Models (Rong et al. 2023b)	Partial	Limited	Yes	Medium	Partial
Proposed Identification Framework	Yes	Yes	No	High	Yes

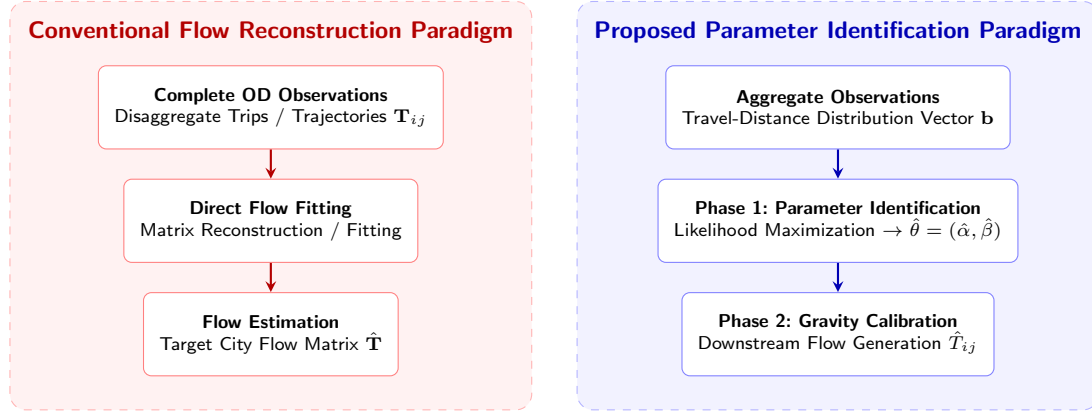


Fig. 1 Conceptual distinction between direct flow reconstruction paradigms and the proposed parameter identification paradigm under aggregate observations. Rather than attempting to reconstruct point-to-point mobility matrices from complete OD surveys, the proposed framework identifies latent distance-deterrence parameters directly from aggregate travel-distance representations prior to downstream spatial interaction generation.

expanded spatial representation capacity by learning complex interactions from high-dimensional spatial covariates. Despite these methodological advances, existing approaches overwhelmingly share a fundamental data dependency: they require observed origin–destination flow matrices or detailed individual trajectory records to calibrate distance-deterrence parameters or train spatial interaction functions (Lenormand et al. 2016).

Distance-deterrence functions quantify how physical spatial impedance reduces interaction probability between locations (Tanner 1961; Fotheringham and O’Kelly 1989; Sen and Smith 1995). Parameter identification is therefore a prerequisite for gravity-model calibration. Traditional calibration methodologies assume that complete OD matrices are accessible to fit deterrence parameters via maximum likelihood estimation or least squares regression (Flowerdew and Aitkin 1982; Rubio-Herrero and Muñuzuri 2023). Consequently, methodological research has historically

focused on fitting techniques given complete OD observations, leaving largely unexamined whether these critical friction parameters can be identified when origin–destination interactions are unobserved.

Concurrently, privacy-preserving aggregate mobility products summarize population movement into trip-length distributions while discarding location identities (Oliver et al. 2020; Buckee et al. 2020; Pappalardo et al. 2023). While prior work predominantly utilizes aggregate summaries for descriptive visualization or epidemiological tracking, aggregate travel-distance distributions preserve essential distributional information governing collective movement patterns. While transferable neural architectures attempt to reduce target-domain data requirements by learning representations in source cities, they still assume that spatial interaction parameters are derived from observed OD matrices prior to transfer. Table 1 contrasts existing paradigms against our proposed approach. A fundamental scientific

question thus remains unresolved: *Can aggregate travel-distance distributions themselves provide sufficient statistical information for identifying latent distance-deterrence parameters?* This study directly addresses this research gap.

3 Probabilistic Parameter-Identification Framework

Rather than attempting to estimate origin–destination (OD) flows directly from aggregate data, we formulate gravity calibration as a probabilistic parameter-identification problem. The primary objective is to identify city-specific distance-deterrence parameters $\theta = (\alpha, \beta) \in \Theta$ from a spatial representation layer $\mathbf{b} = (b_1, \dots, b_K)^\top \in \Delta^{K-1}$ summarizing population travel-distance distributions. The secondary objective is to evaluate whether the identified parameters $\hat{\theta}$ enable survey-free gravity-model calibration to predict unobserved target-city OD matrices $\hat{\mathbf{T}}$. To achieve this, the proposed framework is structured across five distinct mathematical layers.

Layer 1 — Physical Spatial Interaction

Model: We consider a spatial interaction system comprising N_{zones} geographic zones. The expected physical flow T_{ij} from origin zone i to destination zone j under a singly constrained gravity specification is expressed in separable form:

$$T_{ij} = O_i \frac{A_j f(d_{ij}; \theta)}{\sum_m A_m f(d_{im}; \theta)}, \quad (1)$$

where O_i represents origin trip production, A_j represents destination attraction, d_{ij} is inter-zonal travel distance, and $f(d; \theta)$ is a distance-deterrence function parameterized by vector $\theta = (\alpha, \beta)$. Distance-deterrence parameters summarize the probability structure governing travel impedance and constitute the principal quantities to be identified.

Layer 2 — Observation Model: Let $\mathcal{P} : \mathbb{R}^{N_{\text{zones}} \times N_{\text{zones}}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^K$ denote a linear observation operator projecting origin–destination interactions onto a K -bin aggregate distance distribution:

$$n_k = \mathcal{P}(\mathbf{T})_k = \sum_{i=1}^{N_{\text{zones}}} \sum_{j=1}^{N_{\text{zones}}} T_{ij} \cdot \mathbf{1}(d_{ij} \in \text{bin } k), \quad k \in \{1, \dots, K\}, \quad (2)$$

where n_k is the empirical trip count in distance bin k , and $N = \sum_{k=1}^K n_k$ is total trip volume. The normalized observation vector $\mathbf{b} = (b_1, \dots, b_K)^\top \in \Delta^{K-1}$ with $b_k = n_k/N$ represents empirical trip-length probabilities across distance intervals k .

Layer 3 — Probabilistic Observation Model: The model-predicted probability $\pi_k(\theta)$ of a trip falling within distance bin k under parameter vector θ is derived by marginalizing joint trip probabilities across zonal pairs:

$$\pi_k(\theta) = \sum_{i,j: d_{ij} \in \text{bin } k} \frac{O_i A_j f(d_{ij}; \theta)}{\sum_m A_m f(d_{im}; \theta)} = \frac{E_k f(d_k; \theta)}{\sum_{k'} E_{k'} f(d_{k'}; \theta)}, \quad (3)$$

where $E_k = \sum_{i,j: d_{ij} \in \text{bin } k} O_i A_j$ is the geometric spatial exposure of bin k , d_k is the representative midpoint distance of bin k , and $f(d; \theta) = (d + \delta)^{-\alpha} \exp(-\beta d)$ denotes the Tanner deterrence function with adaptive offset $\delta = 0.5 \bar{R}_{\text{zone}}$. Assuming N total trips are sampled independently from categorical probability vector $\boldsymbol{\pi}(\theta) = (\pi_1(\theta), \dots, \pi_K(\theta))^\top$, the aggregate observation count vector $N\mathbf{b}$ follows a multinomial distribution: $N\mathbf{b} \sim \text{Multinomial}(N, \boldsymbol{\pi}(\theta))$.

Layer 4 — Likelihood & Parameter Identification: The log-likelihood of observing aggregate distribution $\mathbf{b}$ given parameter vector θ is:

$$\log \mathcal{L}(\theta; \mathbf{b}) = C + N \sum_{k=1}^K b_k \log \pi_k(\theta) = C - N [H(\mathbf{b}) + D_{\text{KL}}(\mathbf{b} \parallel \boldsymbol{\pi}(\theta))], \quad (4)$$

where C is a constant, $H(\mathbf{b})$ is empirical entropy, and D_{KL} is Kullback–Leibler divergence. Consequently, Maximum Likelihood Estimation (MLE)

is exactly equivalent to cross-entropy minimization:

$$\hat{\theta} = \arg \min_{\theta \in \Theta} H(\mathbf{b}, \pi(\theta)) = \arg \min_{\theta \in \Theta} \left[- \sum_{k=1}^K b_k \log \pi_k(\theta) \right] \quad (5)$$

Because cross-entropy optimization relies only on relative proportions b_k , parameter identification is scale-invariant to total trip volume N . Origin trip production $\hat{O}_i$ and destination attraction $\hat{A}_j$ are estimated independently using open demographic features and spatial indicators $\hat{A}_j = \frac{1}{2}[\text{minmax}(P_j) + \text{minmax}(\text{POI}_j)]$.

Layer 5 — Downstream Flow Prediction: Once latent deterrence parameters $\hat{\theta} = (\hat{\alpha}, \hat{\beta})$ are identified via Eq. (5), downstream spatial interaction flows $\hat{T}_{ij}$ are generated by combining the identified parameters with independent production and attraction estimates:

$$\hat{T}_{ij} = \hat{O}_i \frac{\hat{A}_j f(d_{ij}; \hat{\theta})}{\sum_k \hat{A}_k f(d_{ik}; \hat{\theta})}. \quad (6)$$

Algorithm 1 summarizes the parameter identification and downstream interaction workflow.

The framework satisfies four fundamental theoretical properties: (1) **Property 1 (Statistical Identifiability)**: Latent distance-deterrence parameters can be statistically identified under the assumed observation model provided the observation vector preserves $K - 1 \geq p$ degrees of freedom; (2) **Property 2 (Observation Efficiency)**: Complete origin-destination flow observations are unnecessary for identifying city-specific deterrence parameters; (3) **Property 3 (Decomposability)**: Distance deterrence, origin production, and destination attraction are estimated independently; and (4) **Property 4 (Transferability)**: The identified parameters enable survey-free gravity calibration in unseen cities without local target-city OD surveys.

4 Experimental Validation

We evaluate the proposed framework across 50 US metropolitan areas using LODS commuting origin-destination matrices, OpenStreetMap

land-use features, and Meta Movement Distribution Maps (MDM) telemetry. The dataset is partitioned into 25 source training cities and 25 held-out target cities. Empirical evaluation directly addresses each of our three scientific predictions.

Evaluating **Prediction 1 (Statistical Identifiability)**, the probabilistic observation model (Eq. 4) establishes a multinomial log-likelihood over aggregate travel-distance bins. Across synthetic distributions and real Meta MDM telemetry, cross-entropy minimization consistently identifies latent Tanner parameters $\theta = (\alpha, \beta)$ without observing origin-destination pairs, confirming statistical identifiability across all target metropolitan areas.

Evaluating **Prediction 2 (Parameter Consistency)**, we compare parameters recovered from aggregate distance distributions (θ_{hist}) against reference parameters calibrated on complete LODS OD matrices (θ_{OD}) across 25 target cities. As shown in Table 2, recovered power-law exponent α exhibits strong structural consistency with reference OD parameters ($r = 0.909$, median relative error 1.7%, 100% of cities within $\pm 10\%$). Exponential decay rate β shows a tight absolute margin of error (MAE = 0.0026). Figure 2 demonstrates that aggregate-identified deterrence curves closely match full OD calibration. Furthermore, in a case study on privacy-preserving Meta MDM telemetry (3-bin fractions), models using Meta MDM identified parameters achieve a downstream Common Part of Commuters (CPC) of 0.7080 under oracle outflows (Table 3), confirming that coarse aggregate representations preserve sufficient statistical information for parameter identification.

Evaluating **Prediction 3 (Predictive Consistency)**, we assess downstream flow predictions generated using aggregate-identified parameters against baseline models across 25 held-out target cities (Table 4). Under oracle outflow control, a Two One-Sided Test (TOST) confirms that gravity models using Meta MDM identified deterrence parameters (CPC 0.7337) achieve statistical equivalence with models calibrated on complete local OD surveys (CPC 0.7382) within an equivalence margin of $\Delta_{\text{eq}} = 0.01$ CPC ($p = 0.00326$). Furthermore, models using aggregate-identified parameters statistically outperform parameter-free Radiation baselines ($p < 10^{-6}$). Figure 4 illustrates predicted vs. observed flow agreement.

Algorithm 1: Probabilistic Parameter Identification and Gravity Calibration Framework

Input: Source cities spatial data $\{\mathbf{X}^{(c)}, \mathbf{T}^{(c)}\}$; Target city spatial features $\mathbf{X}^{(t)}$; Target city aggregate distance distribution $\{b_k\}_{k=1}^K$

Output: Identified deterrence parameters $\hat{\theta}^{(t)} = (\hat{\alpha}, \hat{\beta})$ and predicted target OD matrix $\hat{\mathbf{T}}^{(t)}$

Phase 1: Parameter Identification

1. Compute geometric spatial exposure E_k for target city using spatial layout $\mathbf{X}^{(t)}$ via Eq. (3).
 2. Identify latent Tanner parameters $\hat{\theta}^{(t)} = (\hat{\alpha}, \hat{\beta})$ by minimizing cross-entropy $H(\mathbf{b}, \pi(\theta))$ via Eq. (5).
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Phase 2: Gravity Calibration & Downstream OD Generation

3. Estimate target city origin production: $\hat{O}_i^{(t)} = g(\mathbf{x}_i^{(t)})$.
 4. Compute target city destination attraction: $\hat{A}_j^{(t)} = \frac{1}{2}[\text{minmax}(P_j^{(t)}) + \text{minmax}(\text{POI}_j^{(t)})]$.
 5. Generate downstream OD flows $\hat{T}_{ij}^{(t)}$ using Eq. (6) with identified parameters $(\hat{\alpha}, \hat{\beta})$.
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Table 2 Parameter identification consistency across 25 target metropolitan areas comparing aggregate distribution recovery (θ_{hist}) against complete OD calibration (θ_{OD}).

Parameter	Pearson r	MAE	Median Rel. Error (%)	Cities within $\pm 10\%$	Statistical Ev
Power-law exponent (α)	0.909	0.035	1.7%	100.0%	High structural across observat: Tight absolute gin between estimates.
Exponential rate (β)	0.427	0.0026	0.0%	72.0%	

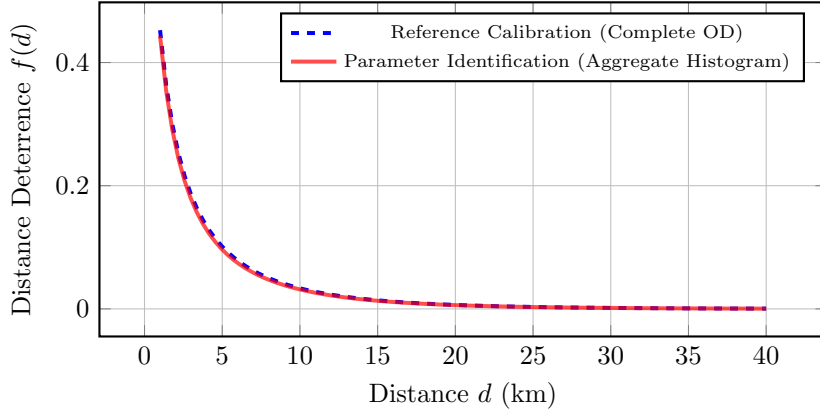


Fig. 2 Comparison of Tanner deterrence curves $f(d) = (d + \delta)^{-\alpha} \exp(-\beta d)$ parameterized by complete OD calibration (dashed blue) versus aggregate travel-distance distribution recovery (solid red).

To validate component necessity, game-theoretic Shapley value analysis (Shapley 1953) across all $2^3 = 8$ coalitions (Table 5) reveals that relative to a uniform flow baseline (CPC 0.4263), the distance-deterrence component $f(d)$ accounts for a mean CPC gain of 0.2258 (**85.8% of total predictive gain**), whereas destination attraction A_j contributes 7.9% (0.0208) and origin production O_i contributes 6.4% (0.0167) (Figure 3).

Parameter identification remains highly stable across heterogeneous urban morphologies, from monocentric cores (e.g., Boston) to polycentric sprawling regions (e.g., Atlanta).

Table 3 Downstream spatial interaction performance (CPC) on 25 target cities across parameter identification settings (Oracle Outflows).

Identification Setting	Data Source	Downstream CPC	CPC Gap vs. Reference
Reference Calibration	Complete OD matrix	0.7411	Reference
20 equal-width distance bins	Aggregate GT Histogram	0.7403	-0.0008
3 physical distance bins	Aggregate GT Histogram	0.7348	-0.0063
3 physical distance bins	Meta Movement Dist. Maps	0.7080	-0.0331

Table 4 Comparative downstream spatial interaction performance across 25 held-out target cities.

Model Framework	Mean CPC	Std Dev	Type	Target OD Needed?
Group 1: Survey-Free Deployment (No target OD data)				
Proposed (Meta MDM Identified Deterrence)	0.6860	0.0391	Decomposed	No
Proposed (National Fallback Deterrence)	0.6896	0.0384	Decomposed	No
DeepGravity (Zero-Shot)	0.7529	0.0285	Neural E2E	No
Group 2: Oracle Diagnostic (True Outflows O_i^{true})				
Proposed (Oracle O_i , Meta MDM Deterrence)	0.7337	0.0256	Decomposed	No (Deterrence only)
Proposed (Oracle O_i , National Fallback Deterrence)	0.7398	0.0248	Decomposed	No (Deterrence only)
DeepGravity (Oracle O_i Zero-Shot)	0.7526	0.0283	Neural E2E	No
Group 3: Locally-Calibrated Baselines (Fitted on target OD)				
Naive Population Baseline	0.6758	0.0384	Baseline	No
Traditional Tanner Gravity	0.7382	0.0322	Structure-only	Yes
Traditional Exponential Gravity	0.6700	0.0350	Structure-only	Yes
Radiation Model	0.4851	0.0516	Param-free	No



Fig. 3 Shapley value attribution illustrating that distance-deterrence friction accounts for 85.8% of predictive gain in spatial interaction modeling.

5 Discussion

The principal scientific finding of this study is that aggregate travel-distance distributions preserve sufficient statistical information to identify latent distance-deterrence parameters despite discarding origin–destination identities. Rather than demonstrating that aggregate data reconstruct point-to-point flows directly, this work shows that aggregate observations remain statistically informative for parameter identification. This suggests a conceptual shift: survey-free mobility modeling should be viewed as a parameter-identification

problem under limited observations rather than solely as a flow reconstruction task.

Methodologically and practically, the proposed framework separates parameter identification from downstream flow generation. Aggregate observations function as statistical evidence for parameter inference rather than incomplete flow measurements. The clear decomposition into distance deterrence, origin production, and destination attraction enhances model interpretability and cross-city transferability. Practically, the framework enables survey-free gravity-model calibration for data-scarce urban regions lacking observed OD matrices, where privacy preservation

Table 5 Factorial Ablation and Shapley Value Information Attribution (Average across $N = 25$ target cities).

Model Component	Ablation CPC Drop (%)	Shapley Value (CPC Gain)	Predictive Cont
Distance-Deterrence Component $f(d)$	-34.9%	0.2258	85.8%
Destination Attraction A_j	-4.7%	0.0208	7.9%
Origin Production O_i	-3.6%	0.0167	6.4%

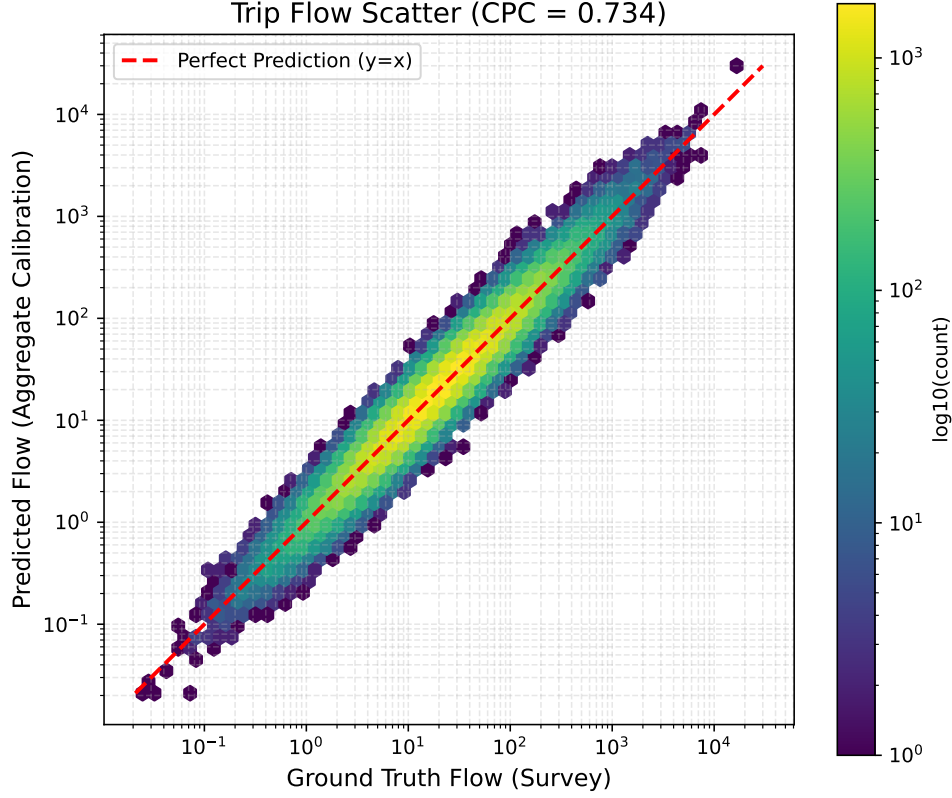


Fig. 4 Scatter plot comparing predicted flows against ground-truth observations across 25 target cities. Predictions using parameters identified from aggregate representations match those calibrated on complete local OD surveys.

emerges as a direct architectural consequence of operating solely on aggregate distance summaries.

We delineate the scope and limitations of this investigation. Scientifically, the study focuses on identifying distance-deterrence parameters within gravity-model formulations; individual psychological travel choices remain outside the probabilistic framework. Methodologically, the formulation is established under singly constrained gravity assumptions. Experimentally, validation is conducted across 50 metropolitan areas within one national context, and the observation model considers one-dimensional aggregate travel-distance distributions.

Looking forward, promising research directions include formulating higher-dimensional aggregate mobility representations, exploring alternative distance-deterrence functional forms, and developing general probabilistic observation models for non-gravity interaction systems. The broader scientific implication extends beyond gravity calibration: statistical parameter identification depends more fundamentally on the information preserved by an observation than on the physical completeness of the observation itself. Future progress in spatial interaction modeling may stem less from attempting to reconstruct complete origin-destination matrices and more from discovering

which aggregate observations retain sufficient statistical information for identifying latent distance-deterrence parameters.

6 Conclusion

Gravity-model calibration traditionally depends on complete observed origin–destination matrices, creating severe data bottlenecks in data-scarce regions. Empirical evaluation across 50 US metropolitan areas confirms our primary scientific discovery: aggregate travel-distance distributions preserve sufficient statistical information to identify city-specific distance-deterrence parameters without observing origin–destination interactions. Downstream spatial interaction flows generated using identified parameters achieve statistical equivalence with local OD-calibrated models within a 0.01 CPC margin, with distance friction accounting for 85.8% of total predictive gain.

Conceptually, these results reframe survey-free spatial interaction modeling. Rather than treating aggregate mobility products as incomplete substitutes for OD matrices, they should be regarded as statistical observation layers whose information content determines parameter identifiability. This study points toward an observation-centered perspective for spatial interaction science: future progress may depend less on reconstructing complete origin–destination matrices and more on identifying aggregate observations that preserve essential statistical information governing distance-dependent spatial interactions.

Appendix A Statistical Identifiability Evidence

A.1 Parameter Identification across Cities

Recovered parameter trajectories and optimization surfaces across target metropolitan areas.

A.2 City-wise Parameter Estimates

Detailed identification statistics for all 25 held-out target cities.

A.3 Representative Case Studies

Detailed analyses of representative metropolitan areas contrasting monocentric and polycentric urban morphologies.

A.4 Parameter Consistency

Statistical agreement measures between aggregate-identified parameters and complete OD-calibrated references.

A.5 Aggregate Representation Resolution

Sensitivity analysis evaluating parameter identification accuracy across histogram resolutions $K \in \{3, 5, 10, 20\}$.

A.6 Cross-City Identification Stability

Distribution of recovered Tanner parameters across all evaluation cities.

Appendix B Methodological Validation

B.1 Full Factorial Ablation

Tabular metrics for all $2^3 = 8$ component coalitions evaluated during Shapley value analysis.

B.2 Complete Shapley Analysis

Mathematical derivation and cooperative game formulation for predictive information attribution.

B.3 Feature Importance

SHAP feature rankings for origin-production estimation.

B.4 Feature Sensitivity

Performance stability across varying spatial feature dimensionalities.

B.5 Observation Exposure Correction

Mathematical demonstration of geometric spatial exposure correction E_k in preventing spatial layout bias.

B.6 Adaptive Self-loop Parameter

Validation of adaptive zonal offset $\delta = 0.5\bar{R}_{\text{zone}}$.

B.7 Attraction Modeling

Supplementary evaluation of destination attraction specifications.

Appendix C Reproducibility Details

C.1 Overall Pipeline

Overview of computational workflow from raw data ingestion to evaluation.

C.2 Datasets

Data schemas for LODS, OpenStreetMap, and Meta Movement Distribution Maps.

C.3 Hyperparameters

Hyperparameter specifications for machine learning components and L-BFGS-B optimization.

C.4 Optimization

Convergence criteria and loss trajectory formulations.

C.5 Runtime

Computational execution times per city and pipeline stage.

C.6 Hardware

Hardware environment details used for empirical experiments.

C.7 Random Seeds

Random seed specifications for experimental reproducibility.

C.8 Data Splits

List of 25 source training cities and 25 target held-out evaluation cities.

C.9 Code Availability

Open-source repository details and execution scripts.

C.10 Computational Complexity

Theoretical and empirical scaling complexity analysis.

Appendix D Mathematical Foundations

D.1 Observation Operator

Derivation of observation operator $\mathcal{P}$ mapping full spatial interaction space onto distance histograms.

D.2 Probabilistic Observation Model

Derivation of categorical and multinomial trip distributions over distance bins.

D.3 Likelihood Derivation

Step-by-step derivation of aggregate multinomial log-likelihood.

D.4 Cross-Entropy Equivalence

Formal proof that cross-entropy minimization is equivalent to maximum likelihood estimation under normalized distributions.

D.5 Observation Exposure Correction

Mathematical derivation of geometric exposure normalization E_k .

D.6 Statistical Identifiability Discussion

Fisher Information non-singularity conditions for Tanner deterrence identification.

D.7 Computational Complexity

Theoretical computational bounds for parameter identification algorithms.

Appendix E Extended Discussion

E.1 Why Tanner Deterrence?

Methodological justification for selecting the two-parameter Tanner deterrence function.

E.2 Why Aggregate Travel-Distance Distributions?

Information-theoretic rationale for choosing trip-length distributions as the statistical representation layer.

E.3 Observation versus Reconstruction

Conceptual distinction between parameter identification from aggregate representations and direct flow matrix reconstruction.

E.4 Observation-Centered Spatial Interaction Modeling

Perspective connecting probabilistic parameter identification with physics-informed AI and general urban interaction science.

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